

# Dhole

*Cuon alpinus*

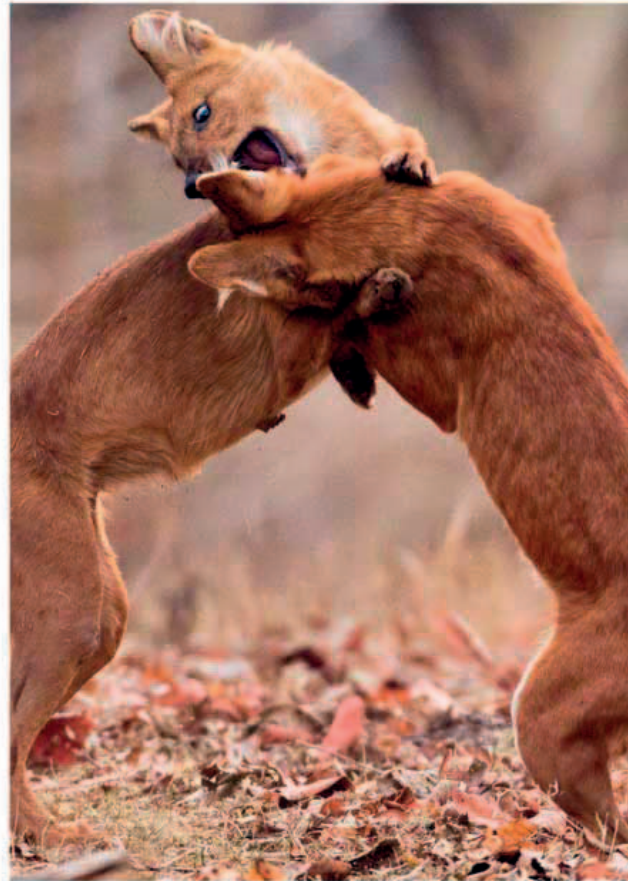
With fewer than 2,500 individuals thought to exist in the wild, the dhole is one of the world's rarest canids. Also called the Asian red dog because of its tawny or dark red coat, it differs from other canids in having a much shorter jaw and two fewer molar teeth. Like wolflike dogs and foxes, however, the dhole has been persecuted as a pest, and is now found in just 40 percent of its former range.

## Strength in numbers

Dholes are extremely social mammals, forming territorial, day-active packs of 5–10 individuals (occasionally up to 30), usually with just one breeding female. Group members readily cooperate to hunt, often chasing deer, but also killing animals up to 10 times their own body weight and aggressive species such as wild boar. Good swimmers, dholes frequently drive deer into water to gain an advantage. They also scavenge from Asian elephant and wild cattle carcasses.

As well as a high-pitched whistle used to call pack mates, dholes use a remarkable range of vocalizations, including mews and screams.

Dholes are nicknamed  
“whistling hunters”



- ↔ 35 in (90 cm)
- ⚖ 33–44 lb (15–20 kg)
- ⊗ Endangered
- 🍖 Deer, insects, lizards, grass
- 🏠



E., SE., and S. Asia

## ◁ PLAY FIGHTING

Social rank within a dhole pack is not established by using aggression—instead it is achieved by pushing or restraining another pack member.

# Golden pheasant

*Chrysolophus pictus*

Few birds are as showy as the male golden pheasant, but ironically, when these gamebirds were brought to Europe for their bright colors, they proved very hard to see in dense conifer forest.

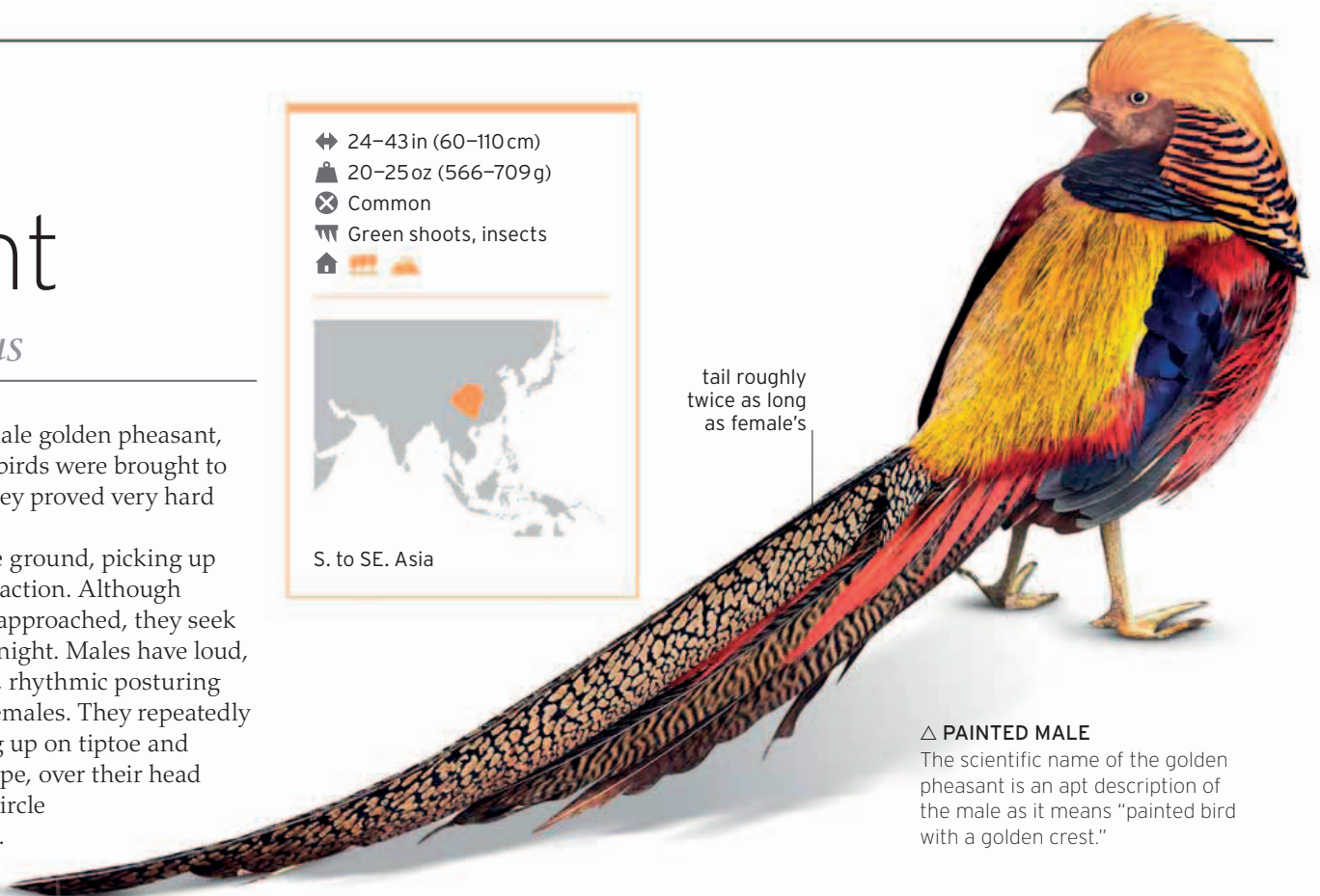
Golden pheasants feed on the ground, picking up food with a precise, chickenlike action. Although tending to run rather than fly if approached, they seek safety and shelter in treetops at night. Males have loud, crowing calls and use ritualized, rhythmic posturing to impress the mottled-brown females. They repeatedly run to “corner” a hen, stretching up on tiptoe and spreading the colorful ruff, or cape, over their head to produce a shiny orange semicircle with concentric blue-black rings.

- ↔ 24–43 in (60–110 cm)
- ⚖ 20–25 oz (566–709 g)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍖 Green shoots, insects
- 🏠



S. to SE. Asia

tail roughly  
twice as long  
as female's



## △ PAINTED MALE

The scientific name of the golden pheasant is an apt description of the male as it means “painted bird with a golden crest.”